

5.3 Plugin management

Plugins are managed from the Plugins panel in the Administration panel of your WordPress site. All plugins listed on this screen are found in your `wp-content/plugins` directory. Each plugin has a description of what it does, an author and web site to refer to, and a version number.

5.3.1 Activation and deactivation

If your plugin requires changes to the WordPress code or your template files, you will need to enact or reverse those changes each time you activate or deactivate your plugin. Failing to do this will likely result in errors. There is also a link provided below the list of Plugins that allows you to activate All Plugins.

5.3.2 Uninstalling plugins

While plugins are very useful, some plugins just don't meet your needs, or you've stopped using them for some reason, or they just don't work. After deactivating the Plugin stops the Plugin's behavior, they tend to pile up in your Plugins panel, making your plugin list long and cumbersome to scroll through. If left there long enough, they might become obsolete with the newer WordPress versions and cause problems if you decide to use them in the future.

To remove a plugin, make sure the plugin is deactivated from the Plugins panel. Go to your web site's `wp-content/plugins` folder (usually with an FTP program) and look for the file name of the plugin you want to remove. Select the file name and delete it.

5.3.3 Things to know before you install

There are a few things you need to know before you install WordPress plugins. Plugins require downloading and uploading to install. You must be familiar with how to download and upload files and how to use FTP, if required. Plugins may require modifying WordPress files and templates. Familiarity with PHP, HTML, CSS, and CHMOD may be necessary.

Record modifications: If you make any changes to the WordPress files or templates, make a note of it in the code by using comments before and after the changes, and in a text file saved to your site and on your desktop to remind you of any additions or modifications to your default files or templates. This will help you repeat these in the future if there are any problems with your site.